

Disagreement

WORD LIST

adversary	belligerent	chide	contradictory	discord
embroil	haggle	ruse	skirmish	strife

From time to time, everyone has disagreements. Children are *chided* by their parents. We might face *discord* with our friends or become *embroiled* in disagreements between others. The words in this lesson will help you understand and write about different types of conflict, the behavior that leads to them, and how they can be resolved.

1. **adversary** (ăd'vər-sēr'ē) *noun* from Latin *ad-*, "toward" + *vertere*, "to turn"

An opponent; an enemy

- His **adversary** had only one rule—to win.

adversarial *adjective* Unfortunately, the two sisters had an **adversarial** relationship.

2. **belligerent** (bə-līj'ər-ənt) *adjective* from Latin *bellum*, "war" + *gerere*, "to make"

Hostile; aggressive; quarrelsome

- The minor argument turned into a **belligerent** shouting match.

belligerence *noun* Because of her **belligerence**, the policemen had to handcuff the woman they had arrested.

3. **chide** (chīd) *verb* from Old English *cidan*, "strife"

To scold; to express dissatisfaction

- Mom **chided** Alice for leaving her slippers out where the dog could chew them.

4. **contradictory** (kŏn'trə-dīk'tə-rē) *adjective* from Latin *contra*, "against" + *dicere*, "to say"

Expressing the opposite; inconsistent

- We were puzzled by the **contradictory** statements of the two witnesses.

contradict *verb* It is not tactful to **contradict** one's coworkers in the presence of others.

contradiction *noun* Bad-tempered at work, yet gentle at home, he was a man of many **contradictions**.



chide

5. discord (dĭs'kôrd) *noun* from Latin *dis-*, “apart” + *cord*, “heart”

Lack of agreement or harmony

- The vacation was ruined by **discord** among the campers.

discordant *adjective* An argument between the two captains set a **discordant** tone for the swim meet.

Discordant sounds, such as those made by orchestra members tuning instruments, lack harmony.

6. embroil (ĕm-broil') *verb* from French *embrouiller*, “to tangle”

To get involved in a conflict, an argument, or confusion

- Try not to get **embroiled** in arguments between other people.

7. haggle (hăg'al) *verb*

To argue or bargain in order to come to favorable terms or a good price

- Some people go to flea markets just for the fun of **haggling** over prices.

haggler *noun* Six-year-old Eric proved to be a true **haggler**, as he talked his father into letting him stay up later and later.

8. ruse (rōos) *noun* from Old French *ruser*, “to drive back”

A crafty trick intended to create a false impression

- The **ruse** succeeded, and the escapees disguised as prison guards vanished into the night.

9. skirmish (skûr'mĭsh) *noun* from Old French *eskermir*, “to fight with a sword”

A minor battle, sometimes on the fringes of a larger battle

- Six people were killed in the **skirmish** that started a civil war.

10. strife (strĭf) *noun*

Bitter conflict or struggle

- **Strife** between ethnic groups in Bosnia resulted in the deaths of many thousands of people.

WORD ENRICHMENT

Oxymorons—language contradictions

If you have ever asked for a *plastic glass*, then you have used an *oxymoron*. Oxymorons are combinations of two contradictory words. Perhaps you have eaten *jumbo shrimp* (shrimp sometimes means “small”) and have commented that they were *awfully good*.

Did you ever look at your shoes and think they were *pretty ugly*? If so, then maybe you polished them to a *dull shine*. Afterward, they may have looked *extremely average*. As you can see, we use *oxymorons* all the time. Can you think of any others?

WRITE THE CORRECT WORD

Write the correct word in the space next to each definition.

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| _____ 1. a minor battle | _____ 6. to scold |
| _____ 2. aggressive; eager to fight | _____ 7. to become involved in a conflict |
| _____ 3. inconsistent | _____ 8. an opponent |
| _____ 4. bitter conflict | _____ 9. to bargain |
| _____ 5. a cunning trick | _____ 10. lack of agreement |

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE

Write the letter for the word that best completes each sentence.

- _____ 1. The parents caused _____ between their children by constantly comparing one to the other.
a. strife b. chiding c. ruse d. embroiling
- _____ 2. The _____ between the committee members was finally resolved when they reached a compromise.
a. chiding b. ruse c. skirmish d. discord
- _____ 3. The _____ leader threatened to attack a neighboring country.
a. contradictory b. haggled c. belligerent d. chided
- _____ 4. Tired of _____ with the plumber about when he could fix the problem, Mom called another company.
a. chiding b. haggling c. contradicting d. embroiling
- _____ 5. Our players failed to discover the other team's _____ until it was too late.
a. strife b. ruse c. adversary d. belligerence
- _____ 6. The small country was afraid of being _____ in the struggle between its neighbors.
a. contradicted b. embroiled c. chided d. haggled
- _____ 7. The _____ evidence seemed both to support and to weaken the suspect's alibi.
a. belligerent b. embroiling c. contradictory d. skirmish
- _____ 8. A minor _____ is better than an all-out war.
a. skirmish b. ruse c. adversary d. contradiction
- _____ 9. Sports events are most fun to watch when the _____ are well matched.
a. adversaries b. ruses c. contradictions d. skirmishes
- _____ 10. Tom's grandmother _____ him for his bad table manners.
a. embroiled b. chided c. haggled d. contradicted

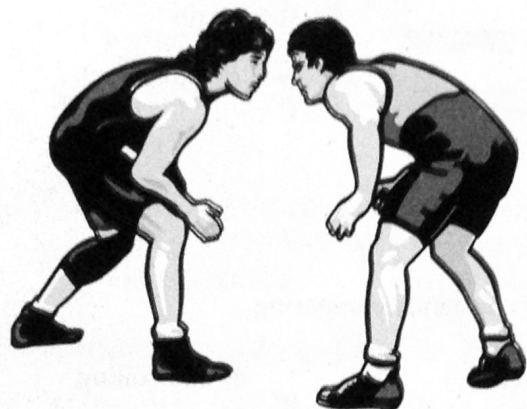
Challenge: While traveling with my family, it felt as though we became _____ in a _____ contest every time we went shopping.

- _____ a. chided...strife b. haggled...discordant c. embroiled...haggling

Champion Female Wrestler

For many years, Patricia Miranda had to fight to compete in the sport she loves—wrestling. But today, she is a successful Olympic contender.

As a child, Miranda was always interested in taking on challenges. One day, as she watched a group of boys in a wrestling class, she decided that wrestling was the sport for her.



Unfortunately, there were no girls' wrestling teams, so Miranda learned the sport by competing with the boys. At times, she found it hard. She had to get used to the pain and bruises from a rough sport. (1) She had to *haggle* with coaches to be recognized as a team member. (2) Some people thought that Miranda's request to join the high-school wrestling team was a *ruse* to get attention, and they didn't treat it seriously. Perhaps most painful were the taunts and mean jokes she had to endure. But Miranda continued her efforts to become a wrestler.

(3) Wrestling is an aggressive sport; at times, opponents and fans can be *belligerent*. Miranda stood five feet tall and weighed just over a hundred pounds. (4) She found it challenging to win against stronger

adversaries. In college, she had trouble even getting a chance to compete in matches. In fact, she had to wait until her senior year to get into the lineup. Even then, she wrestled only after three male teammates were disqualified. She lost far more matches than she won. But finally, one important victory over a male opponent boosted her confidence.

(5) Not all the *skirmishes* Miranda fought were in the ring. (6) She became *embroiled* in a dispute with her father, who initially opposed her decision to wrestle. (7) The cause of the *strife* was her father's concern about her schoolwork. (8) He *chided* her for her interest in wrestling because he worried that it would interfere with her studies. (9) The *discord* ended when they made a deal: Miranda promised that she would get all A's if he would let her wrestle. (10) When she kept her part of the bargain, her father realized that sports and academic excellence were not *contradictory*. Today, he supports her fully.

Slowly, Miranda's skills developed. She did exceptionally well in women's events, winning the gold at the 2003 Pan American Games and the 2003 World Cup. She also took second place in the World Championships in 2000 and 2003. Then, in 2004, women's wrestling was approved as an Olympic sport. That same year, a proud Patricia Miranda earned a bronze medal for the United States at the Summer Olympic Games in Athens.

Today, Miranda, a Phi Beta Kappa graduate of Stanford, is studying law at Yale University. Not surprisingly, she wants to specialize in conflict mediation. Overcoming barriers that stood in her way—teams without a place for her, family opposition, and long strings of losses—Miranda has proved that women belong in wrestling.

Each sentence below refers to a numbered sentence in the passage. Write the letter of the choice that gives the sentence a meaning that is closest to the original sentence.

- _____ 1. She had to _____ with coaches to be recognized as a team member.
a. argue b. spend time c. war d. agree
- _____ 2. Some thought that her request to join the wrestling team was a(n) _____.
a. conflict b. trick c. argument d. struggle
- _____ 3. Wrestling is an aggressive sport; at times, opponents and fans can be _____.
a. inconsistent b. cooperative c. hostile d. entangled
- _____ 4. She found it challenging to win against stronger _____.
a. supporters b. battles c. opponents d. friends

- _____ 5. Not all the _____ Miranda fought were in the ring.
a. minor battles b. clever tricks c. strong enemies d. hostile people
- _____ 6. She became _____ in a dispute with her father, who initially opposed her decision to wrestle.
a. unhappy b. surprised c. dissatisfied d. involved
- _____ 7. The cause of the _____ was her father's concern about her schoolwork.
a. war b. conflict c. harmony d. trickery
- _____ 8. He _____ her for her interest in wrestling because he worried that it would interfere with her studies.
a. congratulated b. scolded c. opposed d. threatened
- _____ 9. The _____ ended when they made a deal.
a. battle b. support c. discussion d. disagreement
- _____ 10. When she kept her part of the bargain, her father realized that sports and academic excellence were not _____.
a. in opposition b. in harmony c. important d. involved

Indicate whether the statements below are TRUE or FALSE according to the passage.

- _____ 1. Success in wrestling came easily to Patricia Miranda.
- _____ 2. For a time, Patricia Miranda's father was opposed to her wrestling competitively.
- _____ 3. Patricia Miranda won a bronze medal in the 2004 Summer Olympic Games.

WRITING EXTENDED RESPONSES

Patricia Miranda fought hard to pursue the sport she loved. Think about a struggle that you, someone you know, or someone you have heard about has been through. Then, in a narrative essay, tell the story of the effort. You may describe a success or a failure. In either case, make sure to give a clear sense of the struggle involved. Your piece should be at least three paragraphs long. Use at least three lesson words in your essay and underline them.

WRITE THE DERIVATIVE

Complete the sentence by writing the correct form of the word shown in parentheses. You may not need to change the form that is given.

- _____ 1. Mom seems to enjoy _____ over meat prices with the butcher. (*haggle*)
- _____ 2. _____ is probably not a quality that will help you make friends. (*belligerent*)
- _____ 3. Governments can become _____ in hostile actions when peaceful diplomacy fails. (*embroil*)
- _____ 4. Faced with a larger and stronger opponent, a smaller force may resort to clever _____ in order to achieve victory. (*ruse*)

- _____ 5. After starting several _____ in the schoolyard, the girl was suspended.
(skirmish)
- _____ 6. Dad always _____ me for eating too fast. (*chide*)
- _____ 7. The phrase "tough love" may seem to be a _____. (*contradictory*)
- _____ 8. Political _____ is best settled at the ballot box. (*strife*)
- _____ 9. I'm sorry you took a position that was _____ to mine. (*adversary*)
- _____ 10. The _____ feelings within the group spoiled the atmosphere of the party.
(*discord*)

FIND THE EXAMPLE

Choose the answer that best describes the action or situation.

- _____ 1. Something your mother might *chide* you for
a. passing a test b. cleaning up c. winning a prize d. not studying
- _____ 2. Usual goal of a *ruse*
a. to argue b. to learn c. to deceive d. to reward
- _____ 3. An example of *strife*
a. a violent riot b. a loud concert c. a card game d. a long parade
- _____ 4. Likely *adversaries*
a. doctors and patients b. lawyers and clients c. teachers and students d. police and thieves
- _____ 5. Something you might get *embroiled* in
a. an argument b. an oven c. a microwave d. a test
- _____ 6. A feeling most closely associated with *discord*
a. hope b. unhappiness c. wonder d. curiosity
- _____ 7. Something a *belligerent* person is most likely to do
a. nourish b. protect c. attack d. whisper
- _____ 8. Something one would *haggle* about
a. a feeling b. a cloud c. a dream d. a price
- _____ 9. Something most likely to cause a *skirmish*
a. peace b. good relations c. good grades d. threats
- _____ 10. Something *contradictory*
a. opposite opinions b. similar reasons c. unrelated facts d. consistent evidence